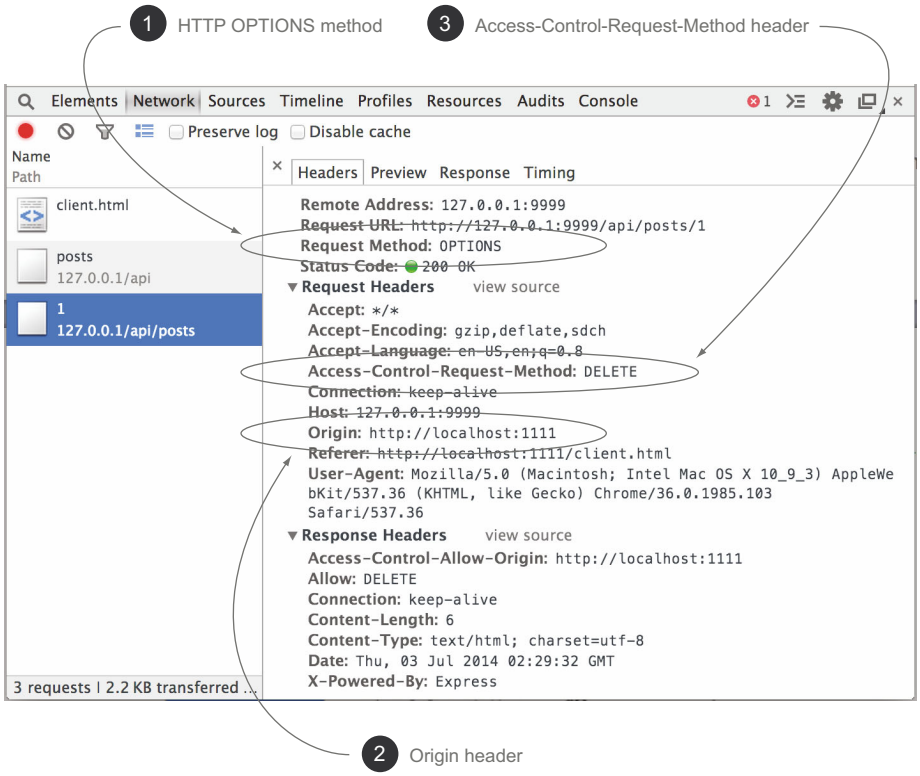


Figure 4.9 The pieces of a preflight request

The Origin header tells you where the request is coming from. The value of the Origin header on a preflight request is the same value as the Origin header on the actual request. So if you're making a CORS request from http://localhost:1111, the Origin header on the preflight request will also have the value http://localhost:1111.

4.3.2 HTTP OPTIONS method

A preflight request must be made via the HTTP `OPTIONS` method, which is defined by the HTTP spec and isn't specific to CORS. The HTTP spec (RFC2616) defines an `OPTIONS` request as "a request for information about the communication options available on the request/response chain." This means that even before CORS, clients could use the `OPTIONS` method to learn more about an endpoint. When used outside of CORS, the `OPTIONS` method traditionally conveys which HTTP methods are supported on a particular URL. Table 4.1 shows an example of a non-CORS `OPTIONS` request to a server. The Allow response header is used to indicate which HTTP methods are supported at the /api/posts endpoint, without triggering an actual request to the /api/posts endpoint.